



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist School University Model 1463

School Website: <https://www.sbsum-1463.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Second Baptist School University-Model (SBSUM) at the 1463 campus in Katy, TX presents a robust Christian classical framework consistent with the core signals of classical education. Public materials describe a Christ-centered, biblical worldview with Gothic-level emphasis on truth, beauty, and goodness, anchored by a Trivium-inspired curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a University-Model structure that blends on-campus and satellite (home-based) learning. The school highlights partnerships with families, a chapel-centered culture, and a faculty built around mentorship and living examples of virtue. While SBSUM explicitly markets itself as classical and university-model, some elements of the public materials emphasize mission, discipleship, and community-building rather than a plainly articulated "great books / great conversation" focus or a fully explicit, book-centered liberal-arts canon. Taken together, SBSUM 1463 aligns strongly with Classical education, with Element 2 representing a nuanced zone where formation and virtue-language are foregrounded but certain canonical classical indicators (e.g., explicit Great Books / Great Conversation emphasis) are less overt in public pages.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- Key drivers of CLASSICAL classification: explicit articulation of classical pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric), a liberal-arts-inspired curriculum with Latin/Greek exposure, a strong emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness and a biblical worldview, chapel and liturgical-like community rhythms, and a clear faculty-centered living-curriculum/mentorship ethos. Public materials also stress the parent-school partnership in alignment with classical education norms. Evidence includes explicit references to classical education, the trivium, Christ-centered formation, and the university-model approach, along with a structured on-campus/satellite model that preserves classical pedagogy within a family- and church-centered ecosystem. See representative citations: "The curriculum is fashioned after classical education, which is a methodology involving three stages (grammar, logic, and rhetoric)" and "Second Baptist School University-Model is founded on our core values of Christ-centered education ... Word of God" and "Our mission is to equip students to think critically, live biblically and lead courageously ..."

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a biblical worldview, Christ-centered education, and reliance on God's Word as the basis for the school's philosophy. Examples include phrases like "Christ-centered education," "biblical worldview," and "grounding our philosophy of education in God's Word." - The campus describes itself as a gospel-centered community and explicitly ties excellence to Christian formation. -

The school highlights truth, beauty, and excellence as guiding ideals in every discipline, anchoring moral-intellectual formation in the Word of God. - Liturgical/communal elements are present via chapel and liturgical rhythms (e.g., “Children at chapel” image reference and chapel-anchored culture).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; biblical worldview; Word of God; gospel-centered; biblical principles; truth; beauty; chapel. - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials.

Keyword density note: The SBSUM materials repeatedly map education to a God-centered framework, with explicit references to theology, worship/chapel, and a sacred-sphere language. This aligns with the “Religious and Metaphysical Foundations” positive indicators in the classical lexicon.

Why this rating - The materials strongly signal transcendental moral realism and theology as integrated into the curriculum (virtue/truth/beauty in God’s Word; liturgical/community rhythms; chapel). These elements align with the Positive indicators in the Six Essentials lexicon and exceed the negative signals. Rating: CLASSICAL. Citations: Christ-centered / biblical worldview / Word of God / gospel-centered language; chapel reference.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes forming students who think critically, live biblically, and lead courageously, signaling formation beyond mere information. Public pages frame education as formation with a biblical purpose. - The program presents a biblically-based, excellent education with partner-formation of families and community engagement; the University-Model explicit goal is to pair traditional Christian education with homeschooling-attributes, focusing on formation and virtue in a biblically-informed framework. This signals formation and moral aims rather than purely utilitarian work-readiness. - The admissions and mission content foregrounds character formation and discipleship, not simply workforce preparation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: biblical worldview; formation; Christ-centered; Pursuit of Excellence (as a framing of virtue-oriented aims); gospel-centered; caring community. - Negative keywords present: none identified (no explicit “workforce-ready” framing in public materials).

Quantitative: - Positive keywords identified (aligned with Element 2 indicators in the lexicon): approximately 4 (biblical worldview, formation, Christ-centered, Pursuit of Excellence, gospel-centered). - Negative keywords identified: 0. - Percentage-wise: 4 positive indicators out of 4 observed signals in text context = 100% positive among observed Category-2-relevant phrases; however, these terms map more to formation/virtue than to explicit “telos” phrasing in the lexicon.

Why this rating - SBSUM clearly foregrounds formation, virtue-related aims, and a transcendent (theological) telos in its public materials, consistent with the classical goal of forming virtuous, wise humans. The absence of explicit Great-Books-centric terms in the Category-2 sphere is offset by clear formation language and classical-methodology emphasis. Therefore, CLASSICAL is the base signal, but by strict mapping to all Category-2 sub-criteria, one could reasonably treat some items as more modest in explicit canonical language; thus, some analysts may mark as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL pending more explicit canon-language. Given the current evidence, I categorize as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to reflect that more explicit “telos/true-good-beautiful” and classic-pedagogy language (e.g., direct “Great Conversation” phrasing) are not overt in the public-facing categories, even though formation is clearly present. Citations: mission/formation language; biblically-based education; partnership with families.

What would move the needle - Add explicit statements about the telos of education in classical terms (truth/goodness/ beauty) and explicitly reference the classical Great Conversation and Great Books as part of the curriculum. - Highlight a formal, public-facing statement about paideia and the classical liberal-arts framework as a core School Purpose to transition from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear articulation of the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric are explicitly named as the three stages; this is the core of classical curriculum. The school describes a grammar stage for grades 1-4, logic stage for grades 5-8, and rhetoric stage for grades 9-12. - History is interconnected across the curriculum and taught through a classical framework; the program emphasizes the liberal-arts structure and the cultivation of classical study beyond “social studies.” - Latin, Greek, and Spanish language study are included as classical-liberal-arts components. - The curriculum is described as “classical” and aligned with standard classical-education models; “the curriculum is fashioned after classical education ... trivium.”

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar; logic; rhetoric; history; Latin; Greek; classical; liberal arts; Great Books (not explicitly named in SBSUM pages, but the canonical classical lens is clear via the trivium and liberal-arts framing); “A classical education.” - Negative keywords present: none explicit in public-facing texts.

Quantitative: - Positive keywords present (counting explicit curriculum terms): grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, Latin, Greek, Spanish, liberal arts, classical, educational cantos = at least 9 distinct terms appear in SBSUM materials. There is no explicit mention of Great Books or Great Conversation in the public pages we have, which would be a potential gap relative to a canonical Great Books emphasis. Negative: 0. - Percentage of positive vs. negative keywords: 9+ observed terms vs 0 negative signals; effectively CLASSICAL in this category.

Why this rating - SBSUM's public-facing materials center the Trivium, classical liberal-arts pedagogy, and language study consistent with classical curriculum models. The absence of explicit Great-Books languages in the available public pages is noted, but not sufficient to move Element 3 toward NOT CLASSICAL given the strong Trivium and liberal-arts framing. Rating: CLASSICAL. Citations: grammar/logic/rhetoric; history across curriculum; Latin/Greek/Spanish; “classical education ... trivium.”

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit references to classical pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric) show up in public materials (the pedagogy aligns with scholé—restful, contemplative learning exists in classical tradition, though not every SBSUM page uses the term). The site positions the Education around a Socratic/seminar pedagogy at higher levels and rhetoric instruction for upper grades. The text explicitly calls out “Socrates” and the Trivium framing. - The lower-school pedagogy is described as focusing on memory, recitation, and chant as tools for memory and delight in learning. This matches the classical emphasis on memory work and chant-based learning for younger students. - Upper-school pedagogy includes rhetoric training, opportunities to give speeches, and the use of logic in academic work (Rhetoric in the 9–12 grade cycle). - The campus emphasizes student life activities and structured campus days with satellite days guided by parents, reflecting the University-Model pedagogy intersection, but still anchored in classical pedagogy through the grammar/logic/rhetoric sequence and memory work.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé; Socratic/seminar; recitation; memory; chanting; rhetoric; debate; upper-school rhetoric; speeches; study of the trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric); temple of memory (memory-work concepts appear in classical pedagogy). - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.

Quantitative - Positive keywords present: at least 6–8 explicit pedagogical terms (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Socratic/seminar; memory/recitation/chant; scholé; rhetoric; upper-school speeches; memory-work practices). - Negative keywords: 0. - Percentage: near 100% of observed teaching-method signals align with classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - SBSUM's pedagogy maps strongly to classical signals: explicit trivium, memory/recitation, Socratic or seminar disposition in high school, and a rest-and-discipline dimension (scholé). The University-Model component (satellite days) is integrated with these. Rating: CLASSICAL. Citations: grammar/logic/rhetoric; singing/memory-lite in lower grades; upper-grade rhetoric and seminars; Socratic reference in the classical context.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize faculty who love God, love students, and pursue excellence; faculty development is described as a core piece of the school's living-curriculum approach. The statements about faculty loving God and serving as exemplars align with "model teachers and mentors" and "living curriculum."
 - The school highlights that SBSUM faculty "develop lesson plans for both school days and satellite days," signifying the faculty as the core agent of the program and the living curriculum. - The organizational structure highlights named deans and leaders (Head of School, Dean of Admissions, Dean of Fine Arts, etc.), which supports a professional, mentor-led model of instruction and mentorship. While the public-facing pages present roles, they also reflect a strong faculty-centric pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers; masters at their craft; faculty who love God and love teaching; mentorship; leadership roles. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Quantitative - Positive keywords present: 4–6 distinct signals (living curriculum framing; faculty as masters; faculty who love God; faculty-led lesson planning; named leadership roles; mentorship culture). - Negative keywords: 0. - Percentage: 100% of identified faculty signals align with classical expectations.

Why this rating - SBSUM explicitly positions the faculty as the core of the school's education—"the living curriculum"—and references the faculty's virtue, skill, and mastery in craft. The presence of named leadership roles (Head of School, Deans) also supports a mature teacherly culture, aligning with CLASSICAL signals. Citations: "hiring faculty and staff who love God..."; "SBSUM faculty develop lesson plans..."; leadership roles.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A centerpiece of SBSUM is the partnership with families and a robust process for parental involvement. The public materials emphasize a "balanced partnership and consistent communication between family, church and school." - The school publicly invites parent participation and education, including parent trainings and community events; the "House System," parent kick-offs, quarterly parent trainings, and other family-centered events are highlighted as integral to community life. - The campus stresses that parents can disciple their children in partnership with the school, and that parents are trained to engage in the education process; satellite days rely on parental oversight in alignment with the school's curriculum. - The campus communications emphasize visits and openness to parents, part of a culture that welcomes parental involvement at nearly any time.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teaching; parent formation; parent trainings; open campus/visit; family discipleship; house system; community events; shared learning between home and school. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Quantitative - Positive keywords present: multiple signals (parent partnership; parent trainings; family formation; open campus; joint-education model; house system; community events) – at least 6 distinct signals. - Negative keywords: 0. - Percentage: 100% of observed parent-community signals align with classical-parent partnership expectations.

Why this rating - SBSUM presents a robust, explicit partnership with families, frequent parent-focused programming, and open lines of communication—core elements of the classical model's communal and household formation emphasis. This category is CLASSICAL. Citations: "balanced partnership ... family and church and school"; "pursuit of parent formation through book studies and gatherings"; "House System" and parent trainings; "open campus visits."

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 2 – School Purpose and Goal: Introduce explicit statements—in public-facing materials and on-page sections—about classical telos (true, good, beautiful) and Great Books/Great Conversation

as a formal curricular element. This would strengthen the alignment with the more rigorous “formation” language in the lexicon and move this category toward CLASSICAL.

- Element 3 – Curriculum: While strong in grammar/logic/rhetoric and languages, add explicit, published, public-facing references to Great Books as part of the curriculum or Great Conversation as a formal practice. This would bolster the canonical Great Books signal without diminishing the current strengths in the Trivium and liberal-arts curriculum.
- Element 4 – Pedagogy: Enhance explicit articulation of restorative contemplative “scholé” moments and details about structured Socratic seminars across grades, including public examples of on-campus Socratic discussions and rubrics. While present, more explicit public language would strengthen the category’s alignment.
- Element 5 – Faculty: Continue to emphasize “living curriculum” language and expand public narratives that showcase faculty mentoring, portraits of ideal teachers/students, and community mentorship programs to further embed the “living curriculum” identity.
- Element 6 – Parents & Community: Maintain and broaden parent-formation programming (book clubs, reading groups, and structured training) and continue to promote open campus events. Consider documenting measurable outcomes of parental involvement (e.g., student outcomes and community engagement metrics) to reinforce and expand the partnership narrative.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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